

English Tenses - Complete Memory Map (12 Tenses)

ENGLISH TENSES

PRESENT TENSES (Now / Habit / Current Situation)

1 Simple Present

Structure:

- (+) Subject + V1(s/es)
- (-) Subject + do/does not + V1
- (?) Do/Does + Subject + V1?

Use:

- Habits
- Facts
- Daily routines

Example:

- I eat breakfast.
- Do you play cricket?

2 Present Continuous

Structure:

- (+) Subject + is/am/are + V1+ing
- (-) Subject + is/am/are not + V1+ing
- (?) Is/Am/Are + Subject + V1+ing?

Use:

- Action happening now
- Temporary actions

Example:

- She is reading.
- Are you listening?

3 Present Perfect

Structure:

- (+) Subject + has/have + V3
- (-) Subject + has/have not + V3
- (?) Has/Have + Subject + V3?

Use:

- Completed action with present result

Example:

- I have finished homework.
- Have you eaten?

4 Present Perfect Continuous

Structure:

- (+) Subject + has/have been + V1+ing
- (-) Subject + has/have not been + V1+ing
- (?) Has/Have + Subject + been + V1+ing?

Use:

- Action started in past and still continuing

Example:

- We have been working since morning.
- Have you been studying?

PAST TENSES (Completed Past Actions)

5 Simple Past

Structure:

- (+) Subject + V2
- (-) Subject + did not + V1
- (?) Did + Subject + V1?

Use:

- Finished action in the past

Example:

- He went to market.
- Did you call her?

6 Past Continuous

Structure:

- (+) Subject + was/were + V1+ing
- (-) Subject + was/were not + V1+ing
- (?) Was/Were + Subject + V1+ing?

Use:

- Action in progress at specific past time

Example:

- She was sleeping.
- Were you watching TV?

7 Past Perfect

Structure:

- (+) Subject + had + V3
- (-) Subject + had not + V3
- (?) Had + Subject + V3?

Use:

- One action completed before another past action

Example:

- I had eaten before 9 PM.
- Had they left already?

8 Past Perfect Continuous

Structure:

- (+) Subject + had been + V1+ing
- (-) Subject + had not been + V1+ing
- (?) Had + Subject + been + V1+ing?

Use:

- Ongoing action before another past event

Example:

- He had been waiting for an hour.
- Had you been studying?

FUTURE TENSES (Future Actions)

9 Simple Future

- Structure:
 - (+) Subject + will/shall + V1
 - (-) Subject + will/shall not + V1
 - (?) Will/Shall + Subject + V1?
 - Use:
 - Future plans or decisions
 - Example:
 - I will go tomorrow.
 - Will you attend?
- **10** Future Continuous
 - Structure:
 - (+) Subject + will be + V1+ing
 - (-) Subject + will not be + V1+ing
 - (?) Will + Subject + be + V1+ing?
 - Use:
 - Action in progress at a future time
 - Example:
 - He will be sleeping at 10.
 - Will she be coming?
- **1 1** Future Perfect
 - Structure:
 - (+) Subject + will have + V3
 - (-) Subject + will not have + V3
 - (?) Will + Subject + have + V3?
 - Use:
 - Action completed before future deadline
 - Example:
 - I will have completed the course.
 - Will you have finished?
- **1 2** Future Perfect Continuous
 - Structure:
 - (+) Subject + will have been + V1+ing
 - (-) Subject + will not have been + V1+ing
 - (?) Will + Subject + have been + V1+ing?
 - Use:
 - Duration of an action up to a future point
 - Example:
 - They will have been working for 3 hours.
 - Will she have been studying?

Ultra-Fast Interview Revision Trick

TENSE FORMULA PATTERN

Simple	→ V1 / V2 / Will + V1
Continuous	→ Be + V1ing
Perfect	→ Have/Has/Had + V3
Perfect Cont.	→ Have/Has/Had Been + V1ing

Present → has/have
Past → had
Future → will have

Present Continuous → am/is/are + ing
Past Continuous → was/were + ing
Future Continuous → will be + ing

🎯 One-Line Memory Shortcut

Present = has/have
Past = had
Future = will

Simple → Action
Continuous → Action in progress
Perfect → Completed action
Perfect Continuous → Duration of action

This single tree is usually enough to revise all **12 English tenses in 5–10 minutes** before interviews, spoken-English practice, or exams.